

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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STANDING IN THE GAP

Ezekiel 22:30 "I looked in vain for anyone who would build again the wall of righteousness that guards the land, who could stand in the gap and defend you from my just attacks, but I found not one." TLB

■ **STANDING IN THE GAP MEANS:**

- * To expose oneself for the protection of something.
- * This means that you take the position on the battlefield in place of a wounded fellow soldier.

■ **WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BRIDGE THE GAP SPIRITUALLY?**

- * The Bible describes prayer as "Standing in the Gap" or "Bridging the Gap" the channel through which God's will is brought to earth.

■ **WHAT IS AN EXAMPLE OF STANDING IN THE GAP?**

- * A dictionary defines "stand in the gap" as "to expose oneself for the protection of something; to take the place of a fallen defender or supporter."
- * Scripture shares numerous examples of people standing in the gap for others and Moses & Esther were two examples of persons who risking their own lives **stood in the gap** for others.
- * Moses begged God not to destroy the Hebrews when they had worshipped the golden calf (**Psalm 106:23**) (**Exodus 32:11-14**).
- * Esther stood in the gap with prayer and fasting for her people, saving them from Haman who wanted all the Jewish peoples destroyed (**Esther 4:15-16**)

■ **STANDING IN THE GAP CAN RELATE TO WHEN WALLS HAS BEEN BREACHED**

- * In ancient Bible time, cities had walls surrounding them to provide protection from enemies. When the wall was breached, the city was vulnerable to destruction and the only way to secure it was for people to risk their lives by physically standing in the gap in the wall and fighting the enemy.

■ **STANDING IN THE GAP CAN ALSO RELATE TO PRAYER, INCLUDING INTERCESSORY PRAYER**

- * Standing in the gap in the form of engaging in **intercessory** prayer to bridge the gap that has occurred between God and those people who are in desperate need of God's miraculous intervention.
- * When a person intercedes on behalf of others and pleads their cause before God **they are standing in the gap between God and those persons**. This ministry of intercession (prayer) is a calling placed on all Christians. **See Romans 8**
- * Persuading prayers for those who are vulnerable and in danger of being overwhelmed by the evil and the devil are those who are taking their position in the gap and waging spiritual warfare against the enemy.
- * Standing in the gap or breach through persistent offering up of prayers with crying's and tears on behalf of those who through sin have causes a gap between themselves and God. (Sinners needing salvation) (**Daniel 9:3**)
- * When we stand in the gap in convincing prayer requesting God's help, mercy, intervention or even forgiveness on the behalf of individuals, communities of people and nations.

■ **STANDING IN THE GAP CAN ALSO RELATE TO LEADERSHIP.**

- * We are told that God desires someone to stand in the gap and make up the hedge ... in the world it also can mean that God is looking for someone - anyone who will practice leadership in the world based on God's Word, God's will, and the moral character of God.

■ **WHO QUALIFIES TO STAND IN THE GAP?**

- * **GOD'S WORD SAYS - SOMEONE – ANYONE – ANY INDIVIDUAL**
- * Here in Ezekiel 22:30 God in His love and desire was to find someone that would find a way to ward off judgment, to dissuade God from the judgment that he purposed to bring on his people because of their sinfulness.
- * God is wanting to show mercy and is looking for a person – just one individual - who has integrity and a deep concern for others and will plead on their behalf for mercy and not judgment.
- * **Where are the righteous leaders in the nation because I am trying to find one person** who will stand in the gap on behalf of their people and **DIVERT** my promised judgment.

■ **WHAT ARE THE BENEFITS OF STANDING IN THE GAP?**

- * By standing in the gap and praying daily for the members in our family, our ties will be strengthened and reinforced by the power of the Holy Spirit and there will be no situation nor circumstance that separate us for each other or from the love of Christ. **Romans 8**

■ **HOW CAN I STAND IN THE GAP FOR MY HUSBAND?**

- * When it comes **to standing in the gap** for your husband, it's important to get YOURSELF off your mind and instead make HIS welfare, HIS faith and God moving and loving HIM the most prominent thing on your mind. Stand on the promises of God.

■ **HOW CAN I STAND IN THE GAP FOR MY WIFE?**

- * And it is the same advice as relating to your spouse- that it's important to get YOURSELF out of your mind and instead totally focus on HER welfare, HER faith, HER Love for God and for him to provide and protect HER.

■ **HOW DO YOU STAND IN A FAMILY GAP?**

- * All Parents need to love their immediate (and extended) family standing in the Gap on behalf of them all trusting and claiming God's Word / promises.
- * Asking God to use YOU to reach out to your children, spouses, and relatives showing love in practical ways while also believing God to do the rest.
- * Your part is to let your light shine and continue to praise God for the resulting fruit.

■ **JESUS THE MEDIATOR**

JESUS BRIDGES THE GAP between finite man and infinite God, between sinful man and a Holy God, between weak people and an omnipotent God.

JESUS bridges that gap by going IN BETWEEN and GIVING his life for all peoples so that we who believe in his sacrifice can be reconciled to God" **I Timothy 2:5**

■ **CAN GOD FIND SUCH PERSONS TODAY TO STAND IN THE GAP?** **Amen Ps Barry**